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Users, Roles and Permissions in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To study how user permissions, roles, data sharing and portal permissions control who can see and do what in the RentEase application, and to verify the Tenant_Profile permission set that limits the tenant portal.

2. Introduction

2.1 Users, Roles and Permissions in Zoho Creator

An application that holds rent, lease and repair data must not show everything to everyone. Zoho Creator controls access in layers. A user is a person who signs in with a Zoho account. A permission is a named set of rights, such as Read or Write, that is given to the users of the application. A role places the user in a hierarchy, and data sharing rules decide which records a user can see. People outside the organisation, such as customers, are added as portal users and are given a portal user permission that limits them to their own part of the application.

2.2 Access in RentEase

RentEase has two kinds of users. The manager and the owner are internal users. The manager runs the rentals from the Command Center, and the owner approves repairs above Rs 5,000 and the deposit refunds. For the demonstration, the admin account acts as both. The internal permissions of the application are Read and Write. The application has one role, CEO, which sits at the top of the hierarchy and can access the data of all other users, and the admin account belongs to it. No data sharing rules have been added, so no extra record sharing is defined beyond the role hierarchy. The tenants are external users, and they work through a single portal built for tenants only, where the Tenant_Profile permission set decides what they can open.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To understand the difference between a user, a permission, a role and a portal permission.
- To identify the internal users and the external users of RentEase.
- To study the Tenant_Profile permission set and the components it gives access to.
- To verify the access given to a tenant portal user.

4. Procedure

1. Open the RentEase application in Edit mode and click Settings in the top bar.
2. Click User Permissions and view its three tabs: Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing, and note that no data sharing rules have been added.
3. On the Permissions tab, note the Read and Write permissions and their descriptions. On the Roles tab, note the role name, the reports-to setting, the share-data-with-peers setting and the associated user.
4. Click Portal User Permissions and open Tenant_Profile. Note, for every form, the Access, View, Edit, Delete and More settings.

5. Open the portal settings of the RentEase portal and check that Tenant_Profile is the default permission set.
6. Open the list of portal users and check that the tenant Rahul Verma is listed.
7. Take a screenshot of each setting. The settings are only viewed and are not changed.

5. Detailed Analysis

Table 1 explains the terms used to control access in RentEase.

Term	Meaning	Use in RentEase
User	A person added to the application with a Zoho account	Admin, acting as manager and owner
Permission	A named set of rights given to internal users	Read and Write
Role	A position in the hierarchy that decides whose records a user can reach	CEO role, held by the admin
Data sharing	Rules that decide which records a user can see	No rules added
Portal user permission	Rights given to external users who sign in to a portal	Tenant_Profile
Portal user	An external person who signs in to a portal with limited access	Tenant Rahul Verma

Table 1: Access control terms in RentEase

Table 2 lists the people who use RentEase and how each of them works with it.

Person	Type of user	Work done in RentEase
Admin	Internal (CEO role)	Builds the application and acts as manager and owner in the demonstration
Manager	Internal (admin account in the demo)	Runs the rentals from the Command Center: leases, invoices, payments and repairs
Owner	Internal (admin account in the demo)	Approves repair costs above Rs 5,000 and the deposit refunds
Tenant	Portal user	Views his lease, invoices and payments, raises maintenance requests and move-out requests

Table 2: Users of the RentEase application

Table 3 lists the two permissions available for internal users.

Permission	Description
Read	This profile will have read permission for all components
Write	This profile will have write permission for all components

Table 3: Permissions for internal users

Table 4 shows the role defined in RentEase and the user who belongs to it.

Role name	Reports to	Share data with peers	Description	Associated user
CEO	None (top of hierarchy)	No	User belonging to this role can access data of all other users	harinisankar.2024.cse_raj17 (admin)

Table 4: Role in the RentEase application

Table 5 shows the components that the Tenant_Profile permission set opens for the tenant portal.

Module	Access	View (report)	Edit	Delete	More
Lease_Agreement	Yes	Lease_Agreement Report	No	No	No
Maintenance_Request	Yes	Maintenance_Request Report	No	No	No
Move_Out_Request	Yes	Move_Out_Request Report	No	No	No
Rent_Invoice	Yes	Rent_Invoice Report	No	No	No
Rent_Payment	Yes	Rent_Payment Report	No	No	No
Property	No	-	No	No	No
Repair_Approval	No	-	No	No	No
Tenant	No	-	No	No	No
Unit	No	-	No	No	No
Vendor	No	-	No	No	No
RentEase_Command_Center	No	-	No	No	No

Table 5: Tenant_Profile permission set

The Tenant_Profile permission set, described as permissions for tenants using the portal, gives access to five forms and shows each tenant the matching report. Edit, Delete and More are not allowed for any module, so the tenant can only submit and view. Property, Repair_Approval, Tenant, Unit, Vendor and the Command Center page are hidden from the portal. Tenant_Profile is the default permission set of the portal, so every invited tenant gets the same limited access. A tenant sees only the records that belong to him. During testing, the tenant reports showed No Data Available because the sample records had been created by the admin and not by the tenant. The permission set itself was correct, and records created by or shared with the tenant appear in the portal.

6. Output

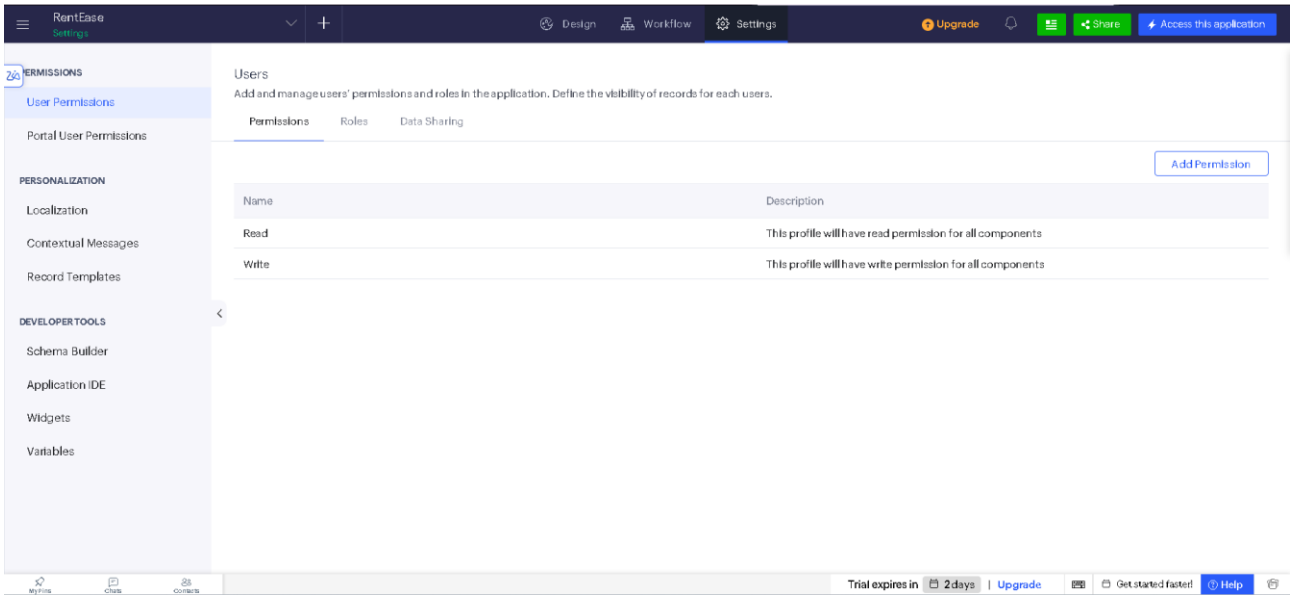


Figure 1: Permissions tab of RentEase

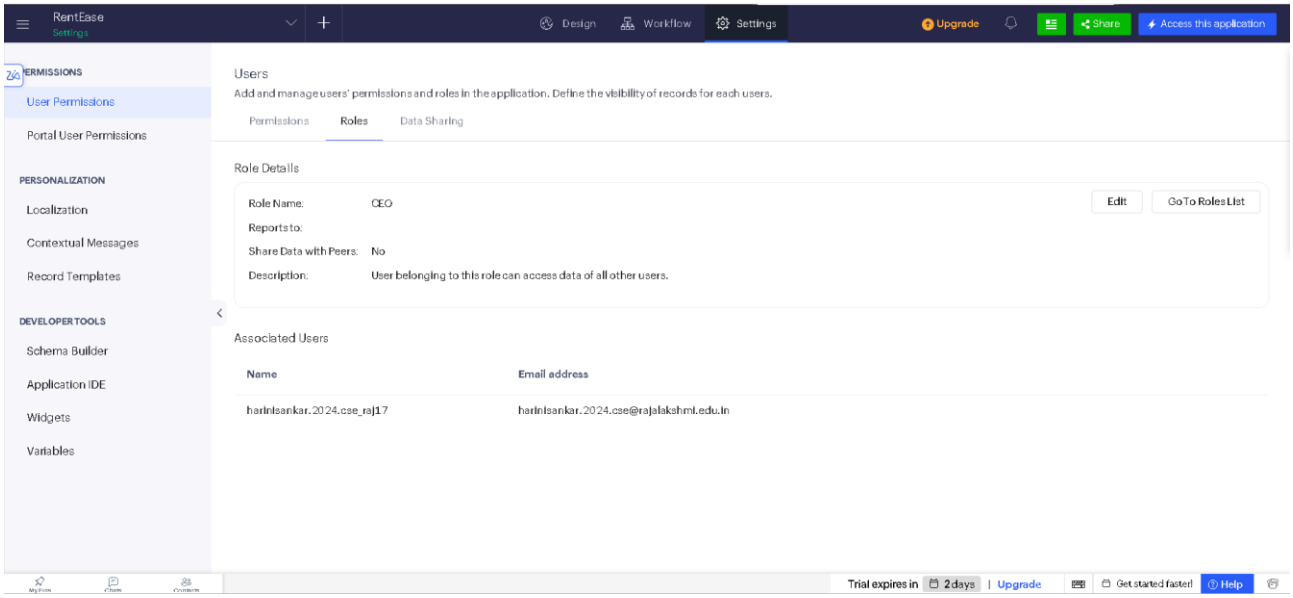


Figure 2: CEO role in the Roles tab of RentEase

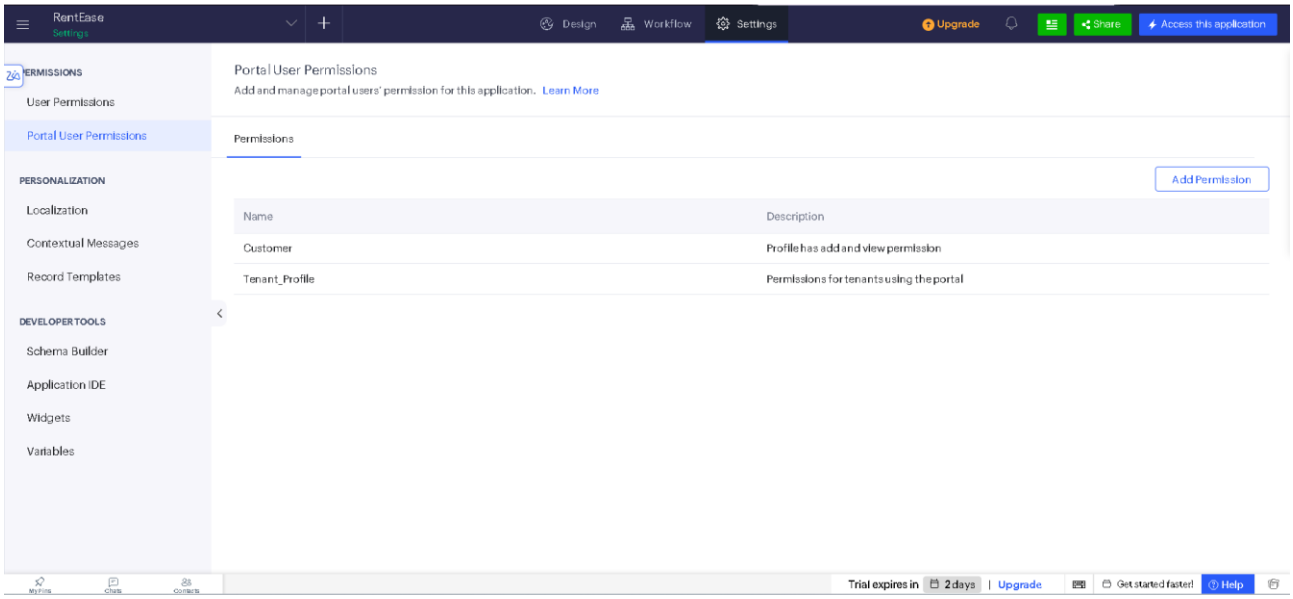


Figure 3: Tenant_Profile permission set

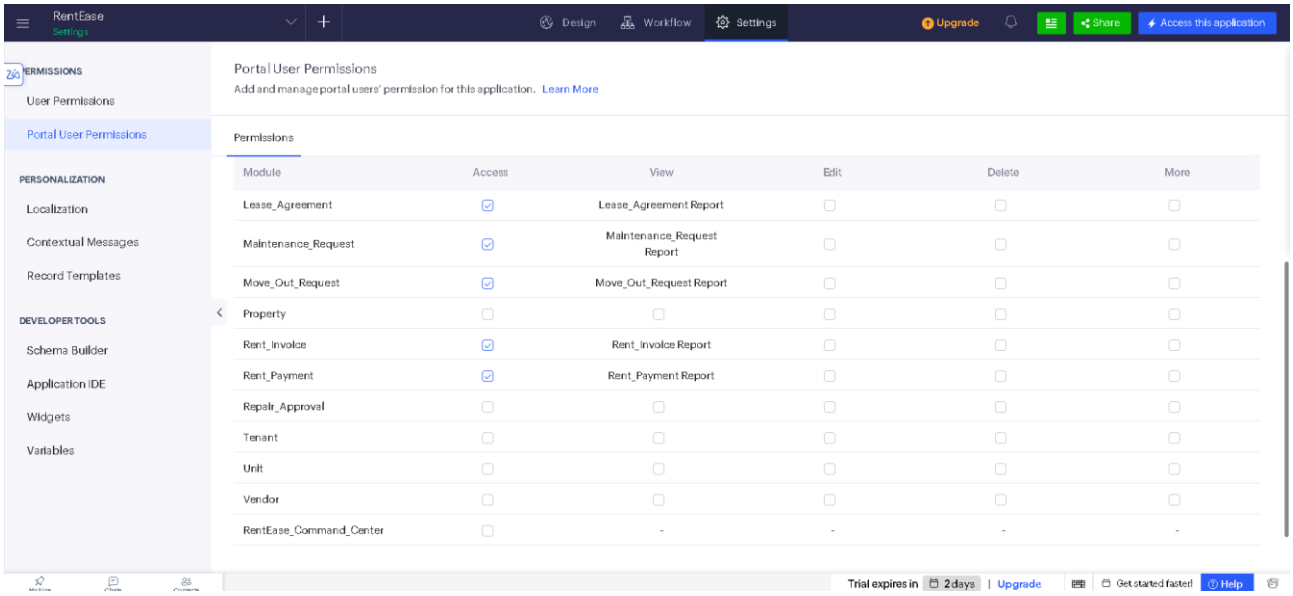


Figure 4: Default permission set of the RentEase portal

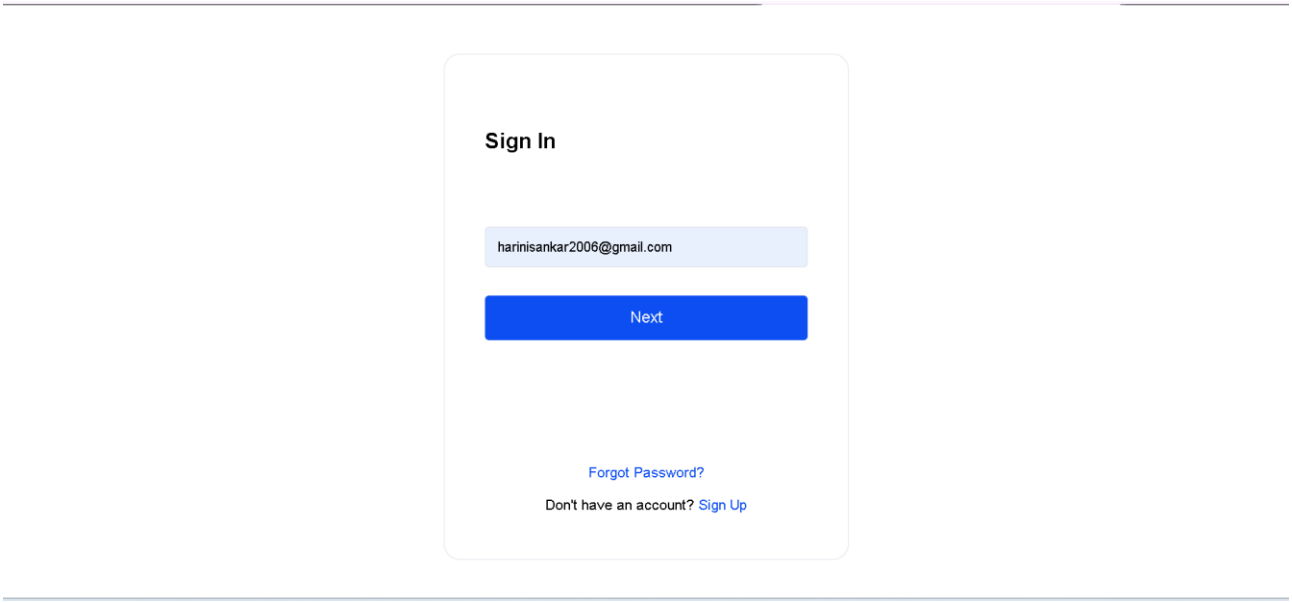


Figure 5: Sign in page for portal user

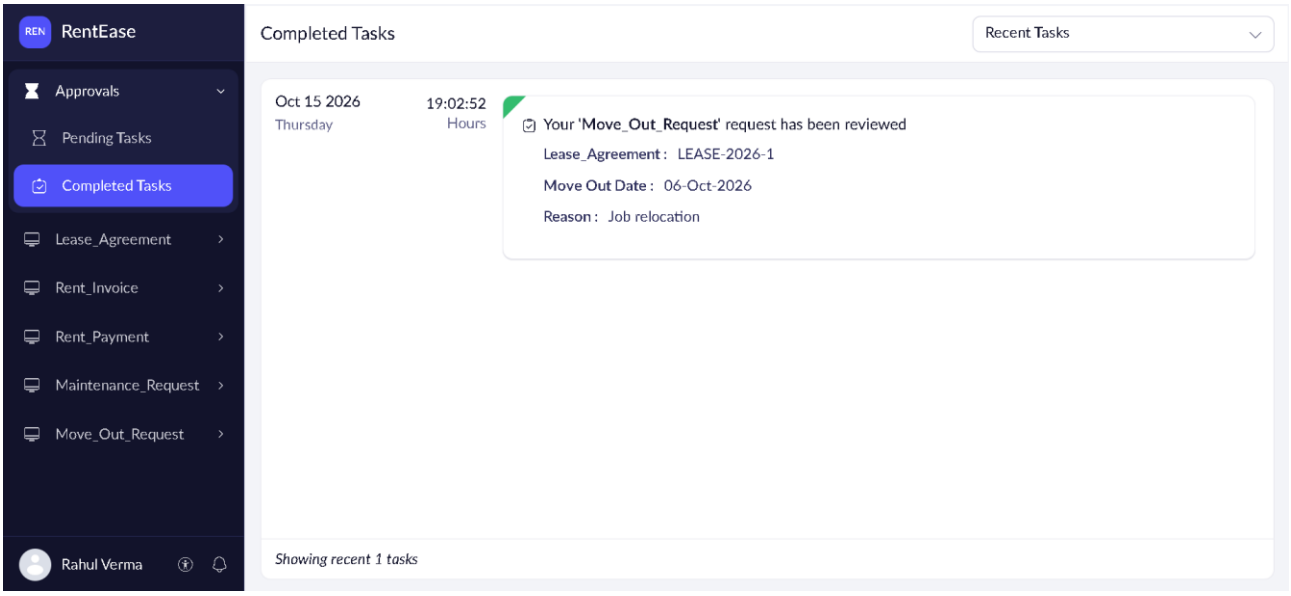


Figure 6: Tenant listed as a portal user

7. Result

The access control of RentEase was studied and verified. The internal users work with the Read and Write permissions, with the admin account acting as manager and owner in the demonstration, and the tenants are external portal users who receive the Tenant_Profile permission set by default. The permission set gives them access to and view of only the lease, invoice, payment, maintenance and move-out reports, with no edit or delete rights, so each user sees only the part of the application that suits his work.